THE DRAMA OF PERFORMANCE
PREPARATION & PRACTICE

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SLIDEHEROES

WHEN 'WINGING IT' MAY NOT BE A GOOD IDEA

- Very important meeting – nothing left to chance
- Goal is to be known for a great presentation – preparation required
- Not very good at improvisation

Preparation & Practice

PREPARATION

PREPARATION PROCESS

SCRIPT: A ROADMAP FOR DELIVERY

- Formal voiceover script of what you will say
- Written down in advance
- Adopt simplified language
- Use as a roadmap during delivery

1 Develop a script

PREPARATION PROCESS

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2. Rehearse script until memorized

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- Use as a roadmap during delivery

1. Develop a script
2. Rehearse script until memorized
3. Use script as safety net

DEVELOPING YOUR SCRIPT

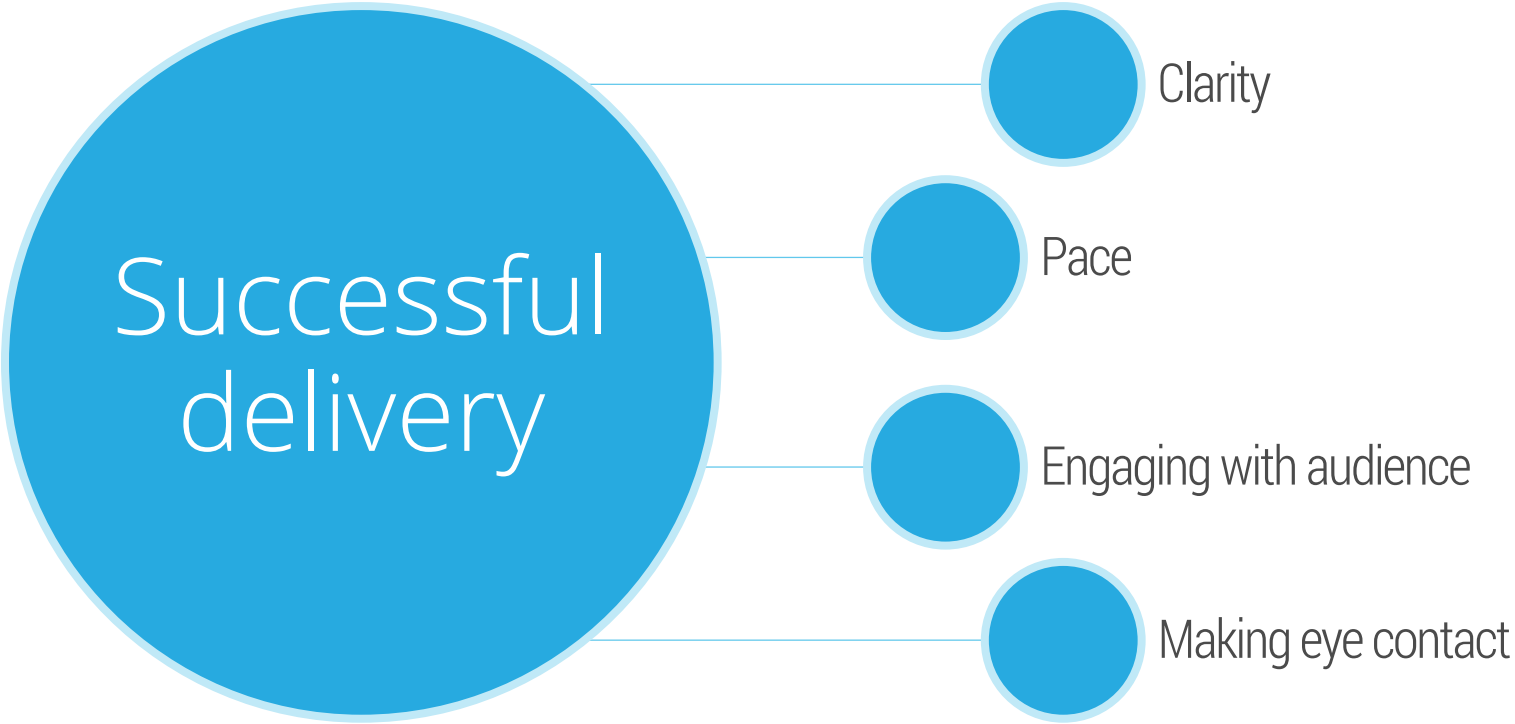
- The script is developed after the deck is written

- It is not a regurgitation of the content already on the slide

Preparation & Practice

DELIVERY FOCUS

CRITICAL FACTORS SUCCESSFUL DELIVERY



Preparation & Practice

DELIVERY FOCUS: CLARITY

PROVIDE ADDITIONAL CLARITY

SIMPLIFY LANGUAGE

The primary goal of your voiceover, of your script, is to provide additional clarity

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INTERPRET SLIDES

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ANTICIPATE QUESTIONS

The primary goal of your voiceover, of your script, is to provide additional clarity

Preparation & Practice

DELIVERY FOCUS: PACE

SPEAKING QUICKLY IMPEDES COMPREHENSION WHEN...

1. The audience's primary language is not your own

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Consciously work at slowing the pace of your delivery

SPEAKING QUICKLY IMPEDES COMPREHENSION WHEN...

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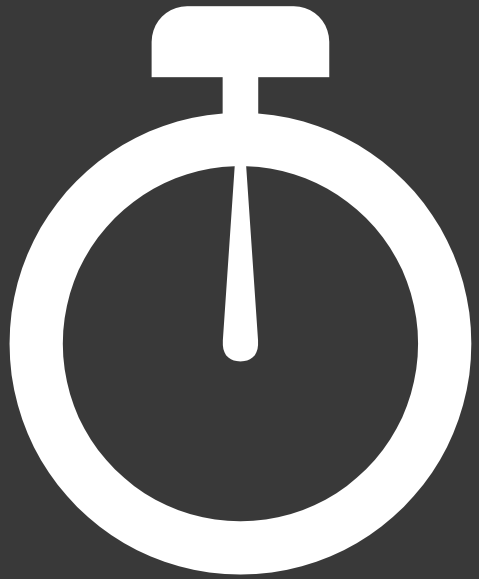
Consciously work at slowing the pace of your delivery

Pause repeatedly and ask if there are any questions as you work through the deck

ENDING ON TIME



- Shorten / cut material in advance

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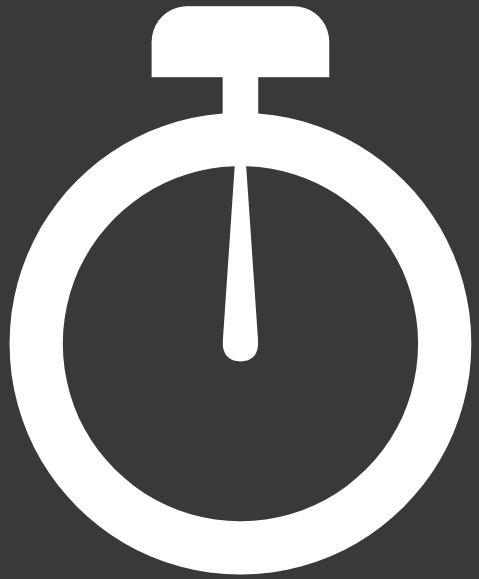

- Shorten / cut material in advance
- Have a mental roadmap of your presentation

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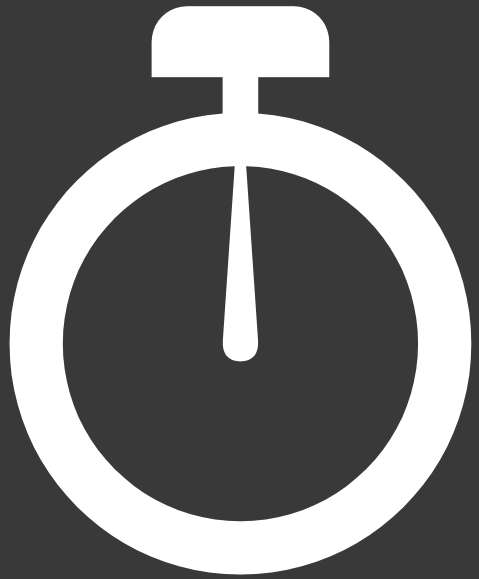

- Shorten / cut material in advance
- Have a mental roadmap of your presentation
- Determine what content to prioritize prior to meeting

Preparation & Practice

DELIVERY FOCUS: ENGAGEMENT

AUDIENCE MAP

PERSONALITY

- What is the personality of your audience?
- What is their style, energy level, and emotional state?

POWER

- Describe the power dynamics of the organization
- How do decisions get made? Consensus / command and control?
- Who is the main decision-maker?

ACCESS

- What's the best way to reach your audience? How do they like to consume information? (Visual thinkers, text-oriented? Like data, intimidated by data?)
- Pre-reads? Will they have read it?

RESISTANCE

- Who are your 'friends' in court?
- What points might resistors latch onto?
- What questions are they likely to ask?
- What push-back might you receive?

MONITORING AND ADAPTING

CUES	ACTION
• Disagreement • Confusion	

MONITORING AND ADAPTING

CUES

- Disagreement
- Confusion

ACTION

- Clarify
- Expand on your point

MONITORING AND ADAPTING

CUES	ACTION
• Disagreement • Confusion • Frustration • Boredom	• Clarify • Expand on your point

MONITORING AND ADAPTING

CUES	ACTION
• Disagreement	• Clarify
• Confusion	• Expand on your point
• Frustration	• Move more quickly through this section
• Boredom	

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CUES	ACTION
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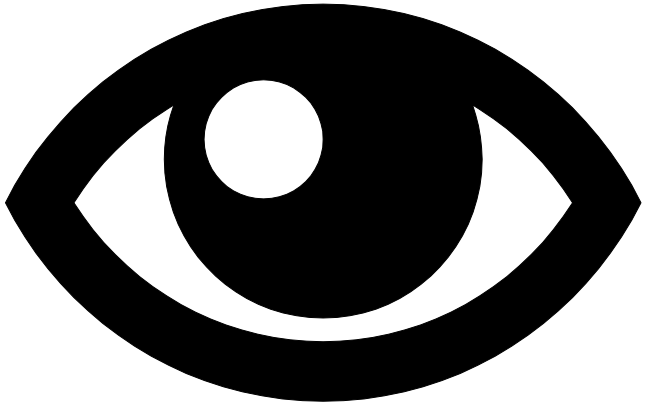
• Frustration • Boredom	• Move more quickly through this section
• Deafening silence	• Pause • Ask for feedback, questions

Preparation & Practice

DELIVERY FOCUS: EYE CONTACT

MAKE EYE CONTACT AND SMILE

- Try and **make eye contact** with key members of audience
- **Do not overly focus** on one or two people
- **Smile.** Do it at the beginning of your presentation

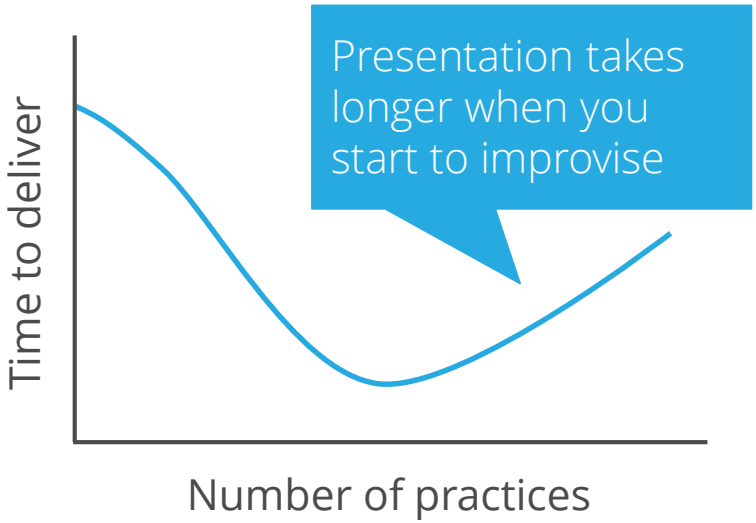


Preparation & Practice

TESTING LENGTH

TEST PRESENTATION LENGTH

DELIVERY TIME DECREASES WITH PRACTICE



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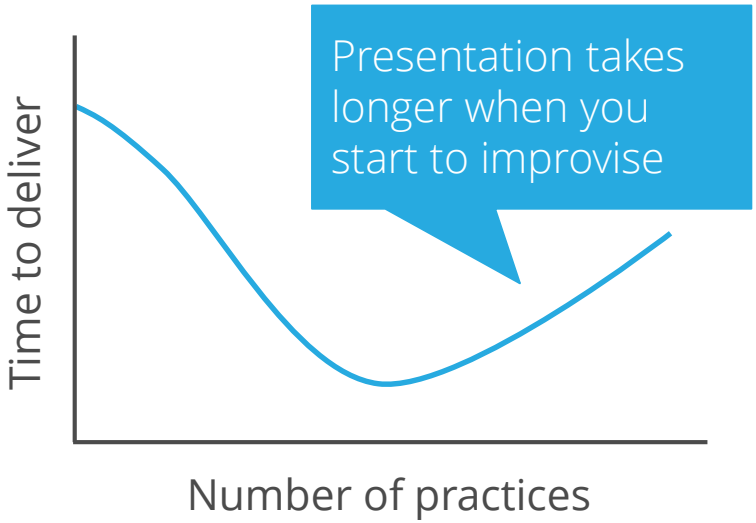

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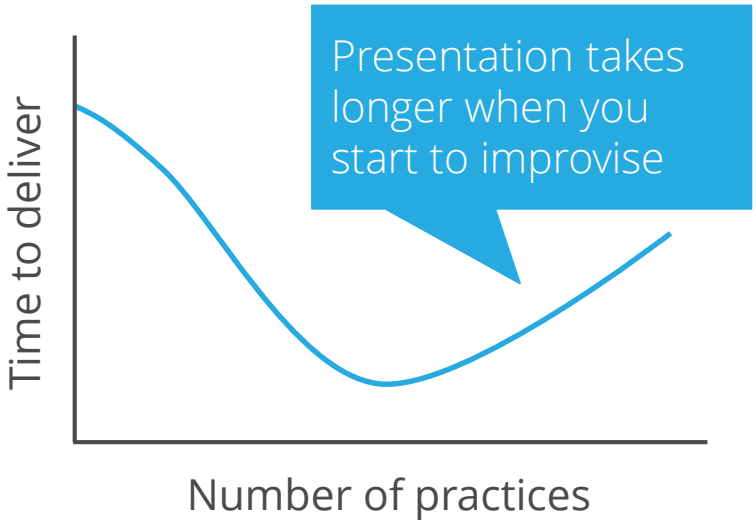

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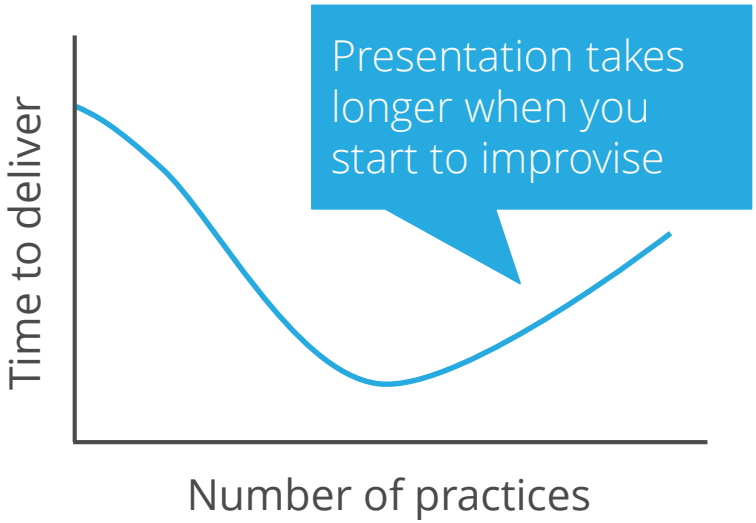

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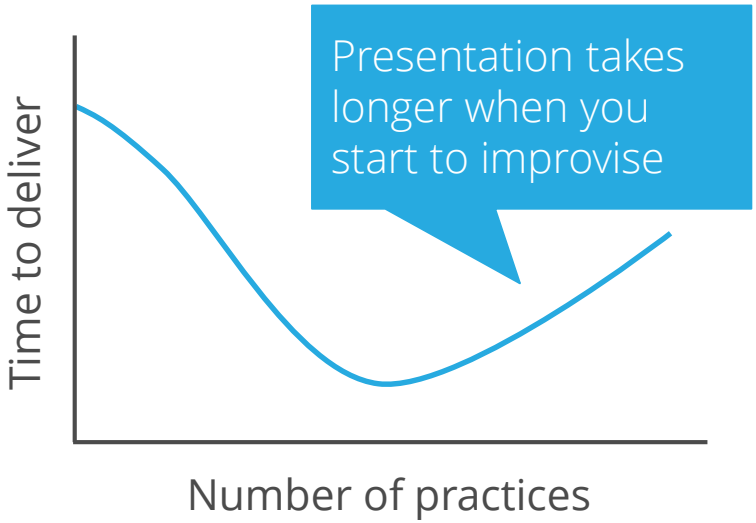

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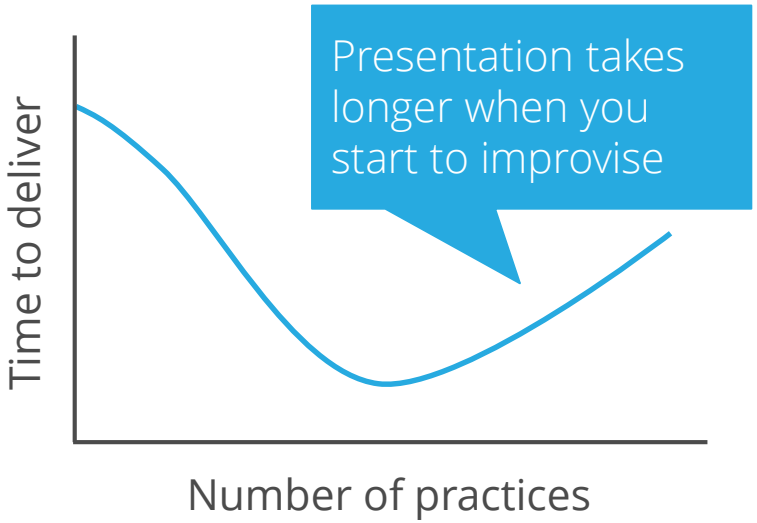

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- **Re-edit deck** to get to optimal length
- Plan on **2 minutes** per slide

Preparation & Practice

PRACTICE

PRACTICE PRACTICE

1. Get feedback on your delivery from someone who is skilled at presenting

2. Present in front of a group to get comfortable with a crowd

Preparation & Practice

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7. Get a good night's sleep; review the script once or twice just before the presentation

LESSON SUMMARY

DEVELOP A SCRIPT
Develop a voiceover script and memorize it

FOCUS ON 4 AREAS
Focus delivery efforts on 4 key areas: Clarity, Pace, Engaging audience, Making eye-contact

CHECK LENGTH
Test the length of your presentation and edit to fit allotted time

PRACTICE
Practice in front of others and solicit feedback

CREATE PLAN B
Develop a shorter 'Plan B' deck